



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

VICTOR BECERRA is rebuilding his house in Altadena, but at least one neighbor has sold their home.

When Altadenans give up on rebuild, developers move in

In the wake of the devastating Eaton fire that tore through Altadena in January, hundreds of signs sprouted up in the ash-laden yards of burned-down homes: “Altadena Not for Sale.”

The slogan signified a resistance toward outside investors looking to buy up the droves of suddenly buildable lots. But as the summer real estate market kicks into gear, not only is Altadena for sale — it seems to be flying off the shelves.

Roughly 145 burned lots have sold so far, around 100 are currently

Sales of scores of burned lots may mean rebirth or doom for the community

By Jack Flemming

listed, and dozens more are in escrow. The identity of every single buyer isn’t clear, because many are obscured by trusts or limited liability companies, but real estate records and local sources suggest that developers are buying the lion’s share of lots.

It’s far outpacing the Palisades market, where fewer than 60 lots have sold since the fire and roughly 180 are sitting on the market, sometimes for months.

The roughly 250 lots sold and listed so far [See Altadena, A9]

State could lose U.S. funds for high-speed rail

Trump administration says its compliance review finds ‘no viable path’ forward.

By COLLEEN SHALBY

The Trump administration found “no viable path” forward to complete California’s high-speed rail project after a nearly four-month investigation that jeopardizes \$4 billion in federal funding.

In a 310-page compliance review released Wednesday, the Department of Transportation cited budget shortfalls, missed deadlines and a misleading projected ridership to connect San Francisco to Los Angeles via fast rail. The review targets federal grants for construction in the Central Valley. Those funds could be pulled within the next 37 days following the high-speed rail authority’s response.

The California High-Speed Rail Authority “relied on the false hope of an unending spigot of Federal taxpayer dollars,” the Federal

Railroad Administration’s acting administrator, Drew Feeley, wrote. “In essence, CHSRA has conned the taxpayer out of its \$4 billion investment, with no viable plan to deliver even that partial segment on time.”

The high-speed rail authority disagreed with the findings, which it called “misguided” and an inaccurate reflection of the project.

“The Authority will fully address and correct the record in our formal response,” a spokesperson said. “We remain firmly committed to completing the nation’s first true high-speed rail system connecting the major population centers in the state.”

Authority leaders previously sounded the alarm over the potential loss of federal funding while voting on new contracts to move forward on construction and design in the Central Valley. Chief Executive Ian Choudri has said that public-private partnerships will be key to the project’s future — an idea that has also been raised by a state-appointed [See Rail, A6]



J. SCOTT APPLEWHITE Associated Press

HOUSE SPEAKER Mike Johnson (R-La.) discusses President Trump’s tax and spending legislation.

Cost concerns add to bill debate

Trump’s spending proposal could steeply increase national debt, the CBO reports.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — Landmark legislation proposed by the Trump administration would add \$2.4 trillion to the national debt over the next decade, a steep increase in deficits amid growing concern in Washington and on Wall Street over the country’s fiscal stability, the nonpartisan Congressional Budget Office said Wednesday.

The CBO report, which also found that 10.9 million more Americans would be without health insurance by 2034 because of the bill,

comes amid searing criticism from one of President Trump’s most prominent allies, Elon Musk, over spending levels in the legislation that he labeled an “abomination.”

The independent budget office also found in a separate report that Trump’s tariffs, if left in place at existing levels, would cut annual deficits over the next 10 years by roughly the same figure. That finding could provide the president with ammunition in the political battle ahead over the future viability of the bill. But that same CBO report found his tariff policy would severely shrink the U.S. economy.

The assessments are fueling debate over the legislation, known as the “One Big Beautiful Bill Act,” on Capitol Hill, where senators are [See Budget, A6]

No body cameras in CHP shooting

Agency’s lag in using the devices means questions persist in a man’s February death.

By NATHAN SOLIS

The sound of more than a dozen rapid-fire gunshots sent Angela Rivera running down her street.

It was about 2:30 a.m. and moments earlier, her son had driven by while being pursued by several California Highway Patrol cruisers.

When Rivera reached the source of the gunfire, she realized her 21-year-old son Sei-Jah Rivera was mortally wounded by a dozen gunshots from a lone CHP officer. Three other officers chasing Rivera did not fire their weapons, but authorities say Rivera had pulled a gun and the shooting officer perceived he was under immediate threat.

While there is CHP dashcam footage from that morning of Feb. 26, the shooting itself isn’t captured on camera. That’s because, experts say, the CHP had, until recently, been stubbornly slow in deploying body cameras within its ranks.

“There is no reason in this day and age, when the camera technology is so readily available, to not have body-worn cameras on off- [See Shooting, A12]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

BOMB damage last month at American Reproductive Centers in Palm Springs.

2nd clinic bombing suspect is returned to U.S., arrested

Prosecutors say man supplied chemicals in Palm Springs attack, then fled to Europe.

By RICHARD WINTON AND BRITNY MEJIA

A man from Washington state is facing terrorism charges in connection with last month’s attack on a fertility clinic in Palm Springs, federal authorities announced Wednesday.

Daniel Park, 32, has been charged with providing and attempting to provide material support to a terrorist, said U.S. Atty. Bill Essayli,

the top federal prosecutor in Los Angeles.

Park is accused of helping Guy Edward Bartkus secure 270 pounds of ammonium nitrate, an explosive precursor that can be used to construct homemade bombs.

Bartkus, 25, is suspected of detonating a bomb at American Reproductive Centers in Palm Springs on May 17, killing himself and injuring four people. The blast created a debris field spread across 250 yards, Essayli said.

Days after the bombing, authorities say, Park left the U.S. for Europe. Polish law enforcement detained him Friday, and he was arrested

Tuesday night at John F. Kennedy International Airport in New York after being deported, authorities said. When Park was confronted by Polish authorities, he attempted to harm himself, according to an FBI affidavit.

Park made his initial appearance in federal court Wednesday afternoon in Brooklyn, N.Y., and was ordered detained.

Park is accused of shipping about 180 pounds of ammonium nitrate in January and later paying for an additional 90 pounds of the chemical to be shipped to Bartkus in the days leading up to the Palm Springs attack.

[See Bombing, A12]

USNS Harvey Milk could lose name

California leaders decry possible renaming of vessel, erasing honor for slain gay activist. CALIFORNIA, B1

Angel City coach focused on bonds

Former Bayern Munich leader brings reputation for inspiration to a club in seventh. SPORTS, B10

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Clouds, then sun. L.A. Basin: 74/59. B6

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Hurdles await Musk at Tesla

The EV maker’s sales, reputation tanked as he advised Trump. Can he fix course? BUSINESS, A8

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